



Samsung Galaxy S4 in India

Samsung launched its one of the most powerful smartphone Galaxy S4 in India, with a price tag of ₹41,500



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Display Resolution 101

Display resolution; an oft-glanced upon term that defines a basic property of any digital screen worth its salt. Here we explain the meaning of the term and highlight popular acronyms related to screen resolutions that are well worth knowing.

A significant part of our modern digital life is spent looking at digital screens, be it the small screen of your Android smartphone or the wide-screen display of that bulky expensive 3D television you bought last Diwali, and a myriad other display-equipped gadgets and gizmos that pass us by – don't forget the one found at your choice of ATM kiosk. What is display resolution, you may ask? Well, simply put, it's the multiplication of the number of pixels squeezed into the width and height of any digital screen – it's also popularly referred to as pixel resolution.

QVGA – It's popularly defined as an array of 320x240 pixels. The QVGA screen revolution took place due to the explosion of early mobile phones, PDAs and even gaming consoles, back in the late '80s through '90s. We remember the Sega Mega Drive and the bottom screen of the original Nintendo 3DS to have proudly shown off their QVGA displays. But in today's age, for the most part, QVGA has been outdated as far as screen resolutions are concerned.

VGA – Short for Video Graphics Array, the lowest standard screen resolution supported by pretty much any digital screen today. An analog display standard, VGA comprises of a 640x480 pixel grid and it was made popular by IBM decades ago, and once the era of personal computers took off VGA screens popped up everywhere. Trivia: Every Microsoft splash-screen prior to Windows Vista is displayed in VGA mode. It does make you feel kind of old, doesn't it?

SVGA – If you ever used a 15-inch CRT monitor back in the '90s and early 2000s, chances are you would've experienced SVGA or Super Video Graphics Array resolution, originally defined as a grid of 800x600 pixels – it was later extended up to 1024x768 pixels. WSVGA (a wide-screen version of SVGA) came



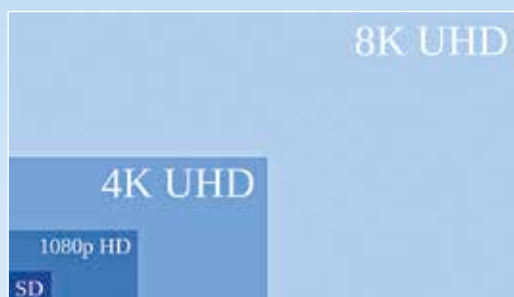
into prominence for a 2-year spell when net-books were ruling the roost and their 10.1-inch large screens proved ideal for the 1024x600 pixel grid.

XGA – The most widely used and prevalent pixel resolution on digital screens all over the world, XGA or Extended Graphics Array. An IBM standard, XGA ruled the roost on PC displays for close to decades and according to most reports charting the total online traffic in the world, screens sporting XGA 1024x768 resolu-

tion are still the most dominant ones out there. HD ready) screens have sported a standard 1366x768 pixel resolution – its broader definition now encompasses any screen resolution with 720p. With the advent of mobile PCs (smartphone, laptops, tablets, and the like), the HD resolution came into prominence and for the first time the screens we were so used to peering in became substantially wider than they were taller.

Full-HD – Probably the term that's been thrown at technology consumers the most in the past couple of years, Full-HD (as far as digital screens are concerned) is the array of 1920x1080 pixels. So an HDTV or widescreen monitor can only be called "Full-HD" if it truly supports the 1080p resolution. A big push towards adopting Full-HD or 1080p as the de-facto widescreen standard came from content producers and broadcasters. Now, all of us are obsessed with Full-HD screens and video, aren't we?

4K or Ultra HD – This term's going to be thrown around a lot for a few years to come, so it's best to know what all the fuss is about. 4K or Ultra HD resolution is a screen standard of 3840x2160 pixels which conforms to a 16:9 aspect ratio and it has twice the number of horizontal and vertical lines and four times the total number of pixels compared to Full-HD screens. Expect a large number of TV manufacturers to launch Ultra HDTVs with a 4K resolution for the very first time throughout this year.



A resolution chart to help things along

tion are still the most dominant ones out there. WXGA – a widescreen variant of XGA – is defined differently for screens of different aspect ratios, but the most well-known among them is the 1280x800 pixel resolution grid adopted by Apple MacBooks for a number of years.

HD – For anyone who bought a laptop in the last five years or so, you are already accustomed to the HD resolution and a virtual window sporting a 16:9 aspect ratio. HD (or